

Calvinism Teaches Regeneration is Before Faith (Wrong!)

By David Michael Curtis

The sequence of events according to Calvinism is:

1. Regeneration comes first (Wrong!).

The Wikipedia page on "Limited atonement" shows that for most Evangelicals, Christians receive salvation through faith. But not so for Calvinists, who teach that salvation is by God's sovereign will through Election. That through God's sovereign decree, a person is dead, totally depraved, and becomes regenerated as the first step by no will or cooperation on his part.

Justification: Calvinism, Confessional Lutheranism, & Arminianism

Topic	Calvinism	Confessional Lutheranism	Arminianism
Justification	Justification is <u>limited to the</u> <u>predestined to salvation</u> , completed at death. *	Justification <u>for all men</u> (universal atonement), completed at Christ's death and resurrection and received through faith alone.	Justification <u>was made possible for all</u> <u>through Christ's death</u> but only completed choosing faith in Jesus.

* Notice that under Calvinism, faith is not mentioned. Why? For the Calvinist, justification is by God's sovereign will, not by faith.

Source: [Wikipedia: "Limited atonement"](#)

GOD'S PLAN OF SALVATION

Yes, to God's Sovereignty, No to Divine Determinism.

Yes, to Election, No to Double Predestination.

Yes, to Depravity. No to Total Depravity.

Yes, to Atonement, No to Limited Atonement.

Yes, to Grace, No to Irresistible Grace.

Calvinism is submerged under a massive swamp of vocabulary drowning in philosophical terminology. This terminology appears before simple minds as sanctimonious truths they come to trust in because learned men teach them. But under its surface, this appearance, which closely parallels certain truths in the Bible, actually derails the minds of the simple, corrupting their minds from the truth.

2 Corinthians 11:3 But I fear, lest by any means, as the serpent beguiled Eve through his subtilty, **so your minds should be corrupted from the simplicity that is in Christ.**

The simplicity that is in Christ.

- Christ died for the sins of the whole world.
- Christ was resurrected on the third day.
- Christ triumphantly returned to Heaven, and God has accepted His sacrifice on the Cross, and you have the atonement now.

Our message to everyone is that Christ has made peace between you and God. If you would like eternal life, **believe** the gospel, **repent** of your sins, **be baptized**, and you will be saved.

Calvinism is not a simple gospel.

Calvinism is not a simple Gospel; it requires years of training in several textbook-sized systematic theology books to understand, let alone explain it

to anyone else. But it all starts with the idea that **regeneration comes first (Wrong!)**. Every domino that follows this first one in Calvinism introduces its disciples to another double election, another Jesus, that provides another limited atonement. Which, like Catholicism, has experts that say all the right things and appears sanctimonious when it is defended through debate.

Calvinists love debate.

In the name of Jesus, I charge you to avoid Calvinists at the peril of your soul.

Romans 16:17-18 Now I beseech you, brethren, mark them which cause divisions and offences contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them. For they that are such serve not our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly; and by good words and fair speeches deceive the hearts of the simple.

Why avoid them? Calvinism is a universe created by brilliant ideas that originated in history's greatest minds, including Augustine, Calvin, Edwards, Piper, Sproul, and MacArthur. Calvinism's arguments are subtle, clever, and logically make sense within that worldview at every turn. Calvinism's view of scripture is internally consistent and has answers to every objection you can throw at it. In short, you will not convert a Calvinist to Christianity. Your attempts to win with a scriptural presentation will only be met by a philosophical response accompanied by a myriad of historical quotes from iconic names throughout church history to back them up.

I will close this thought with another: the Word of God is incorruptible, unchangeable, authoritative, and confounds the wise using simple things. In a few moments, I will present the case from scripture. Please approach the Bible with reverence and a teachable heart. If you place the Bible's authority over the names I mentioned in the previous paragraph, you won't

be intimidated by them. Trust in the Bible. It is worthy of your trust. Please leave Calvinism behind and say goodbye to it. Leave it at the train station behind us as the train pulls away to take us to the truth.

Regeneration is After Faith

The sequence of events according to the Holy KJV Bible is:

1. Hearing the gospel comes first. “Faith comes by hearing the word of God. Romans 10:17.

- The four types of hearers are good soil, wayside, thorny, and stony ground hearers.

- The good soil hearers understand, believe, and receive the gospel after hearing it.

2. Before hearing the gospel, we are guilty, condemned, and dead in sin.

3. After hearing the gospel, we must repent and be baptized to be saved.

4. Immediately after baptism, the believer is forgiven of sins and given the Holy Ghost.

5. The moment we get baptized, forgiven of sin, and receive the Holy Ghost is the moment we are “saved, by the washing of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost.” Titus 3:5.

In the Gospels, what came first? Forgiveness or miracles?

Matthew 9:2 And, behold, they brought to him a man sick of the palsy, lying on a bed: and Jesus seeing their faith said unto the sick of the palsy; **Son, be of good cheer; thy sins be forgiven thee.**

Matthew 9:5-6 For whether is easier, to say, *Thy sins be forgiven thee*; or to say, *Arise, and walk*? But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (then saith he to the sick of the palsy,) *Arise, take up thy bed, and go unto thine house.*

FORGIVENESS HAPPENS BEFORE REGENERATION!

We were dead in sins.

Ephesians 2:1 And you *hath he quickened*, who **were dead in trespasses and sins**;

Ephesians 2:5 Even when **we were dead in sins**, *hath quickened* us together with Christ, (by grace ye are saved;)

John 3:18 He that believeth on him is not condemned: but **he that believeth not is condemned already**, because he hath not believed in the name of the only begotten Son of God.

Being “quickened” is to be forgiven of sin.

Colossians 2:13 And you, **being dead in your sins** and the uncircumcision of your flesh, *hath he quickened* together with him, **having forgiven you all trespasses**;

Repentance and baptism precede the remission of sins.

Luke 3:3 And he came into all the country about Jordan, preaching the **baptism of repentance for the remission of sins**;

Acts 2:38 Then Peter said unto them, **Repent, and be baptized** every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ **for the remission of sins**, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.

Luke 24:47 And that **repentance and remission of sins** should be preached in his name among all nations, beginning at Jerusalem.

The Spirit quickened Christ.

1 Peter 3:18 For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but **quickened by the Spirit:**

The Spirit is given at Baptism.

Acts 2:38 Then Peter said unto them, repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, **and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost.**

Baptism is into Christ's death.

Romans 6:3 Know ye not, that **so many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his death?**

Matthew 26:28 For this is **my blood** of the new testament, which is shed for many for the remission of sins.

Christ was put to death in the flesh.

1 Peter 3:18 For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that he might bring us to God, **being put to death in the flesh**, but quickened by the Spirit:

It is not quickened, except it dies.

1 Corinthians 15:36 *Thou* fool, that which thou sowest is not quickened, except it die:

Washing, regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost

Titus 3:5 Not by works of righteousness which we have done, but according to his mercy **he saved us, by the washing of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost;**

Conclusion: The notion that regeneration occurs before faith is unscriptural.

First, we hear the gospel, then respond to it through repentance and baptism. The Holy Spirit quickens us at the moment we are forgiven of our sins. Baptism is for the remission of sins. Therefore, we conclude that we are regenerated by the Holy Spirit, which means to be washed from our sins when we get baptized. This is why the only time regeneration is mentioned is in the context of ***washing, regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost!***

Calvinism dissects regeneration, performing surgery on it, cutting it out, removing it from faith, repentance, and baptism, and setting it aside on a shelf. Within Calvinism, faith, repentance, baptism, and forgiveness of sins are not necessary before being regenerated. Calvinism is not God's plan of salvation; abandon it and return to the simplicity that is in Christ.

According to Strong's and Thayer, Regeneration means new birth, being born again, and being washed from sin. Read the four gospels, believe them, repent, and be baptized for the remission of your sins. You will receive the Holy Ghost and be washed from all your sins by the blood of Jesus Christ. This does not require a systematic theology textbook; you only need your New Testament.

